

Ranul Vithanage

Doctoral Student, Imperial College London, London, United Kingdom

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Human Centered AI, Tutoring Robots, Skill Modelling, Human-Robot Interaction, Child-Robot Interaction, Human-Computer Interaction, Learning Science, Cognitive Science, Artificial Intelligence

EDUCATION

Imperial College London, London, UK 2025 — 2029

PhD in Computing (Human-Robot Interaction)

Personal, Assistive, and Intelligent Robotics (PAIR) Lab

University of Moratuwa, Moratuwa, Sri Lanka 2020 — 2024

BSc Eng (Hons) in Mechanical Engineering

First Class & Dean's List in Semesters 1, 2, 7, 8

PUBLICATIONS

R. Vithanage and N. Salomons, “*Modelling Individual Skill in Collaborative Groups – Attribution-based Bayesian Knowledge Tracing*,” manuscript under review, 2026. [Preprint]

R. Vithanage, N. Senaratne, P. Wellangalle, W. Amarasinghe, D. Jayathilaka, and M. Jayawardane, “*Smart Music Therapist 1.0: Rhythmic Auditory Stimulation Integrated Robotic Walker as a Therapeutic Companion for Gait Rehabilitation*,” IEEE International Conference on Robot and Human Interactive Communication (RO-MAN), 2024. [PDF]

R. Vithanage, N. Senaratne, P. Wellangalle, W. Amarasinghe, D. Jayathilaka, and M. Jayawardane, “*Robust Autonomous Summoning Capabilities for a Patient Assistive Mobile Robot*,” IEEE International Conference on Advanced Robotics and Mechatronics (ICARM), 2024. [PDF]

PAPER REVIEWS

IEEE/ACM International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI) 2027 Reviewer

IEEE/ACM International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI) 2026 Reviewer

CONFERENCE ATTENDANCE

CHI PLAY 2026	Student Volunteer	York, UK	03–05 Nov 2026
HRI 2026	Participant	Edinburgh, UK	16–19 Mar 2026
RO-MAN 2025	Participant	Eindhoven, The Netherlands	25–30 Aug 2025
RO-MAN 2024	Virtual Participant		26–30 Aug 2024

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Department of Computing, Imperial College London, UK

Oct 2025 — Present

- 70101 Human-Robot Interaction
- 70015 Mathematics for Machine Learning
- 60038 Generative AI
- X0120 Fundamentals and Innovative Applications of Robotics
- 50008 Probability and Statistics
- 60006/70089 Computer Vision
- 60019/70084 Robotics
- 40012/40018 Discrete Mathematics, Logic & Reasoning

Temporary Lecturer

Jan 2025 — Jul 2025

Department of Mechanical Engineering, University of Moratuwa, Sri Lanka

- Conducting lectures in the modules of Automotive Engineering and Design of Machine Elements
- Conducting Continuous Assessments including tutorials, practicals and Final Paper Evaluations
- Evaluating undergraduate viva, presentations, assignments, and reports.

Temporary Instructor

Jul 2024 — Jan 2025

Department of Mechanical Engineering, University of Moratuwa, Sri Lanka

- Conducting practical lab sessions in the modules of Mechanics, Mechanics of Materials, and Manufacturing Processes for Engineering undergraduate students
- Conducting Familiarization sessions for MATLAB, COMSOL, SOLIDWORKS software
- Evaluating undergraduate viva, presentations, assignments, and reports.

Visiting Instructor

Apr 2024 — Jun 2024

Department of Mechanical Engineering, University of Moratuwa, Sri Lanka

- Conducted practical lab sessions under the module Fundamentals of Mechatronics
- Facilitated workshops on Single-Board Computers (Raspberry Pi), Micro-controllers (Arduino), Image Processing principles and tools for Robotics projects

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Student Travel Grant (USD 2000)

Aug 2024

IEEE Int. Conference on Robot and Human Interactive Communication (RO-MAN) 2024

Pasadena, California

REFERENCES

Dr. Nicole Salomons (PhD Supervisor)*Assistant Professor, Department of Computing, Imperial College London, UK*

E-mail: n.salomons@imperial.ac.uk

Dr. Sen Wang*Associate Professor, Department of Computing, Imperial College London, UK*

E-mail: sen.wang@imperial.ac.uk

Dr. Daniel Tozadore*Lecturer, Department of Computer Science, University College London, UK*

E-mail: d.tozadore@ucl.ac.uk